AI STRATEGY · CANVAS

3-Pillar AI Strategy Canvas

For leadership teams who need to map AI maturity across the three pillars and the governance rail beneath them, then decide where to focus next quarter.

How to use this: Work through each pillar honestly with your leadership team, check the gate before each move forward, score your current state, then set one clear focus for the next 90 days.

How the framework fits together: The pillars set the order: educate, then operationalise, then productise. The governance rail runs underneath all three. Each gate is the minimum governance that must be in place before the business leans harder on the next pillar.

Pillar One: Educate and Empower the Workforce

Assess how much working AI fluency actually exists across the organisation today.

What proportion of the team uses AI tools regularly, and for what kinds of tasks?

Has anyone been given structured, role-specific guidance on what AI is and isn't reliable for?

Where have you seen risky or low-quality AI use go unchecked so far, including on personal accounts?

Gate to Pillar Two

Before AI is written into workflows, these should be true.

- [ ] A named senior owner is accountable for AI across the business.
- [ ] An acceptable use policy has been published and acknowledged by everyone who uses AI at work.
- [ ] There is an approved tools list, and a rule for which data can go into which tools.
- [ ] We have looked for unapproved AI use and either approved it or switched it off.

Pillar Two: Operationalise AI

Assess how much of your current AI use is embedded in workflows versus living as personal habits.

Which business functions use AI as part of a documented workflow, not just individual habit?

Who owns quality and accountability for each AI-assisted workflow in place today?

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What would break if the person who introduced each current AI workflow left tomorrow?

Gate to Pillar Three

Before AI goes into what customers buy, these should be true.

- [ ] Every AI-assisted workflow is in an AI register with an owner, a risk tier and a verification tier.
- [ ] AI vendors behind those workflows have been reviewed, including training and retention terms.
- [ ] We have checked whether any workflow makes or substantially informs decisions about individuals (APP 1.7 from 10 December 2026).
- [ ] The AI incident path has been tested at least once, even as a tabletop exercise.

Pillar Three: Productise AI

Assess how AI shows up, or is expected to show up, in what you sell.

Does your product include any AI-powered feature, and how reliable is it in practice?

What AI-related expectations have customers, prospects, or the board already set for you?

What is the actual evidence (not assumption) that a proposed AI feature is ready for customers?

Gate to Launch

Before an AI feature reaches paying customers, these should be true.

- [ ] Impacts on customers and their end users have been assessed, including who could be harmed and how they can raise concerns.
- [ ] The feature has been tested before release against the failure modes that matter, and is monitored after it.
- [ ] Customers are told when they are interacting with AI, and our privacy policy covers any automated decisions.
- [ ] We can answer an enterprise AI questionnaire about the feature, and have an AI addendum ready.
- [ ] There is a working human override or alternative pathway for anything that affects an individual.

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Maturity Scoring

Score each row honestly on a 1 to 5 scale (1 = no structured activity, 5 = mature and governed).

Area	Score (1-5)	Evidence for this score	Gap vs. where energy is currently going
Educate and Empower the Workforce			
Operationalise AI			
Productise AI			
Governance rail (owner, policy, register, review)			

Next 90 Days: One Clear Focus

Name the pillar, or the gate, with the largest gap between current maturity and current organisational attention.

The pillar or gate we are prioritising this quarter is:

The single most important action we will take on it is:

The person accountable for this pillar's progress is:

We will know it worked if:

Where This Maps

Framework	Where this document lines up
Australia's Guidance for AI Adoption	Gate to Pillar Two: practice 1. Gate to Pillar Three: practices 1, 3 and 4. Gate to Launch: practices 2, 4, 5 and 6
ISO/IEC 42001	Clause 5 leadership; clause 6 planning and AI risk assessment; Annex A.5 impact assessment; A.6 AI system life cycle
NIST AI RMF	Govern underpins all three pillars; Map, Measure and Manage apply from Pillar Two onwards

General guidance, not legal advice. References to standards show where this document aligns; adopting it does not make an organisation compliant or certified. Check your specific obligations with a qualified adviser. Regulatory references checked October 2026.

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